

Lesson plan

Slide;

1. NA
2. Consider question and share ideas
3. Learning journey
4. Share answer
5. Introduce Islam and its origins
6. Check learning with questions
7. Share reading, read the first paragraph, answer question and feedback
8. Read the remaining information
9. Complete comparison table
10. Share answers
11. TEACHER TALK - IMPORTANT NOTE FOR THE VIDEO
12. Share video, apuse often, add to table
13. Check answers of additions to the table
14. Whiteboard quiz
15. Whiteboard quiz
16. Whiteboard quiz
17. Whiteboard quiz
18. Whiteboard quiz
19. Whiteboard quiz
20. Whiteboard quiz
21. Whiteboard quiz
22. Complete plenary

By the end of the lessons students need to know;

1. The cause of the division in Islam
2. The impact of this division on the way each faith is practiced

What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?



"Ummah" means the global community of Muslims.

If all Muslims belong to one "Ummah," why might they have different groups or "denominations"?

ONE UMMAH



Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

Unit 6 - What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

Core concepts



Belief



**Worship
and Ritual**



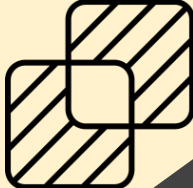
Community

1. What is the history of Islam in Britain?



1

2. What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?



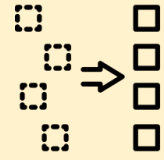
2

4. What is the role of the Mosque in the community? *



4

6. Does Islam align with the British Values?



6

3. What does it mean to grow up Muslim and British?



3

5. Is Islamophobia an issue in Britain?



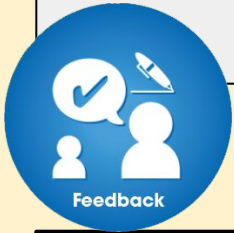
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7. What does the future hold for British Muslims? *



7

What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?



While all Muslims belong to one **Ummah** (global family) because they share core beliefs—like the oneness of God (**Tawhid**) and the **Quran**—they are also individuals with different histories.

Just as Christianity has **denominations** like Catholics and Protestants, Islam does too.

These differences usually started over **leadership** (who should lead?) and **interpretation** (how should we practice our faith?).

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?



How Did Islam Begin?

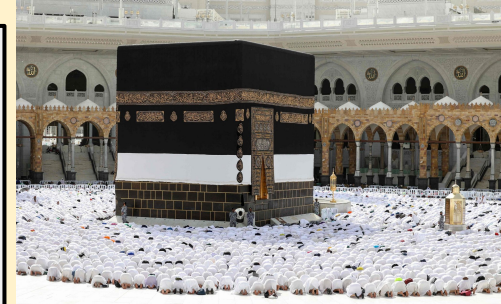
Islam began in the 7th century CE in the city of Makkah (Mecca), in modern-day Saudi Arabia.

Muslims believe that Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was chosen by God (Allah) to receive revelations. These revelations were delivered by the Angel Jibril (Gabriel) and later became the Qur'an, the holy book of Islam.

Muhammad (PBUH) taught that there is only one God and encouraged people to live with honesty, justice, mercy, and compassion. At first, many people in Makkah rejected his message, and some Muslims were treated badly because of their beliefs.

In 622 CE, Muhammad (PBUH) and his followers travelled from Makkah to the city of Medina. This journey is called the Hijrah and marks the beginning of the Islamic calendar.

In Medina, Muhammad (PBUH) became both a religious and political leader. Islam continued to spread across Arabia, and many people accepted the religion.



Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

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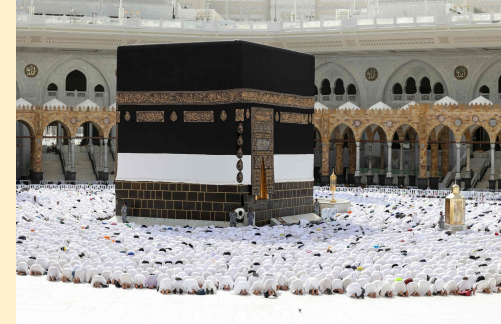


Where did Islam begin?

What was revealed to the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH)?

What did Muhammad (PBUH) teach?

When did Muhammad (PBUH) travel to Medina?



Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

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Feedback



Read It

How did Islam split?

Read the first section of the sheet as a class and answer;

- What happened to cause a split into Shia and Sunni groups?

The death of the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) led to the split in Islam.

The Year 632 CE: A Turning Point

The Death of the Prophet

- In 632 CE, Prophet Muhammad died in the city of Madinah. He was the religious leader of Islam and the leader of the Muslim community, called the Ummah.
- After his death, Muslims had an important question:
 - Who should lead the Muslim community now?
 - Muhammad had not clearly said who the next leader should be. Muslims disagreed about the answer. This disagreement later led to the two main branches of Islam: Sunni and Shia Islam.

The Sunni View

Most Muslims believed the new leader should be chosen for the Muslim community. They believed the best person should lead, even if they were not part of Muhammad's family.

- They chose Abu Bakr, who was Muhammad's close friend and father-in-law.
- Abu Bakr became the first Caliph.
 - A Caliph is a successor or leader after Muhammad.
- These Muslims became known as Sunni Muslims.
 - The name Sunni comes from the word Sunnah, meaning the teachings and example of Muhammad.

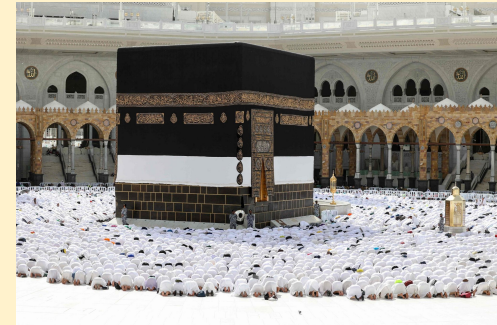
The Shia View

A smaller group of Muslims believed God wanted leadership to stay within Muhammad's family.

- They believed Ali ibn Abi Talib, Muhammad's cousin and son-in-law, should become the next leader.
- Shia Muslims called their leaders Imams.
 - An Imam is a spiritual leader guided by God.
- These Muslims became known as Shia Muslims.
 - The name Shia comes from Shi'at Ali, meaning "Party of Ali".

Did Conflict Happen?

- At first, the disagreement was mostly peaceful, although there was tension between the groups.
 - Abu Bakr became the first Caliph; Ali later became the fourth Caliph.
- Over time, the disagreement about leadership became permanent. This created the two main branches of Islam today: Sunni Islam and Shia Islam.



Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

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Now read the rest of the sheet



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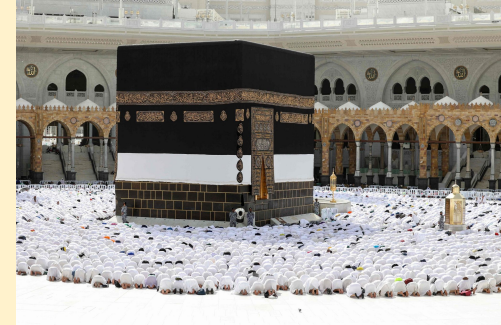
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Practice

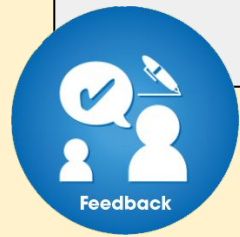
Using the information you have just read complete the first 5 rows of the table.

Feature	Sunni Islam	Shia Islam
Prophet Mohammed (PBUH)		
Who should lead?		
Who was first?		
Title of leader		
Meaning of name		
Other differences		
Similarities		

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

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Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

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What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

On the next slide we will watch a video.

The video includes some artistic images of historical figures linked to the early history of Sunni and Shia Islam.

It's important to know that these are interpretations used to help tell the story, not accurate or religious images.

In Islam, there are different views about showing images of important religious figures, and some Muslims may prefer not to view them. That's absolutely fine. If anyone would prefer not to look at the screen during those moments, you're welcome to do so.

The purpose of the video is to help us understand how Sunni and Shia Islam developed, so just focus on the ideas and information being explained.

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?



Let's upgrade your table now.

Watch the video, pause it regularly, and add extra detail to your table, including the bottom two rows

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Sunni Islam

Shia Islam

Who was first?

Meaning of name

Other differences

Similarities

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

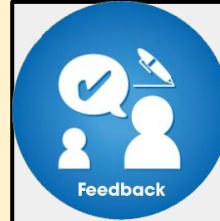
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

In what year did Prophet Muhammad pass away?



Feedback

632 CE



Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

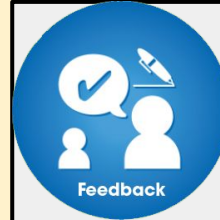
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

The Sunni branch is named after the 'Sunnah'. What does 'Sunnah' mean?



Feedback

Teachings and example of Muhammad (PBUH)

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

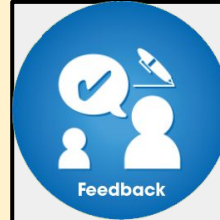
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

The Shia branch is named after 'Shi'at Ali'. What does this phrase translate to?



Feedback

Party of Ali

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

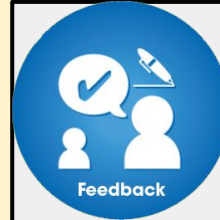
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Practice

Who did the Sunni Muslims follow as their first leader?



Feedback

Abu Bakr

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

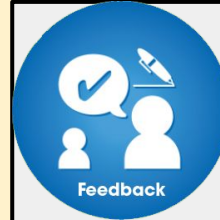
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

Who did the Shia Muslims follow as their first leader?



Feedback

Ali

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

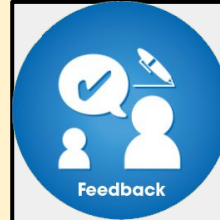
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

What specific title do Shia Muslims use for their divinely inspired leaders?



Feedback

Iman

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

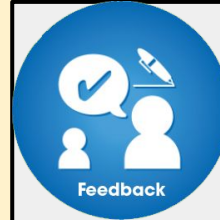
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Practice

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Feedback

Caliph

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

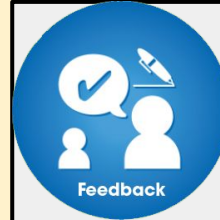
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

Name two things that Sunni and Shia Muslims have in common



Feedback

Both believe in one God, Muhammad (PBUH) is the final prophet, 5 pillars, read the same Qur'an, face the Kaaba in Mecca in prayer, day of judgement, heaven and hell

Lesson question; What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?

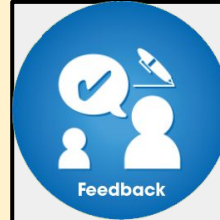
Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

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Practice

What is the name of the concept that refers to the "global family" or community of all Muslims?



Feedback

Ummah

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3

Three things you have learnt today that you did not already know

2

Two things that surprise you

1

One thing you would like to know more about

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